Flag 6 of 18: Staging Archive on the File Server

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Question

What is the file name of the compressed zip archive created by the attacker on the file server to stage sensitive financial audit files?

Answer

Financial_Audit_2026.zip

Evidence

A `FILE_CREATION` event in the Cymbal namespace (list view time 22:26:11):

- Host: `CYM-FS-01.cymbal.corp`, the file server.
- User: `svc_backup`, the service account used for lateral movement.
- Creating process: `C:\Windows\System32\WindowsPowerShell\v1.0\powershell.exe`.
- File name: `Financial_Audit_2026.zip`.

The surrounding events on the same host fit the staging step:

- `svc_backup` logged on from the Denver workstation `CYM-DEN-W10-042` (list time 22:06:21).
- `cmd.exe` was launched by `wsmprovhost.exe` (list time 22:13:11), a WinRM remote session.
- `powershell.exe` was launched by `cmd.exe` (list time 22:19:41), and the archive was created a few minutes later.

Evidence status: the answer was found from the file-creation search result. The full event fields (the folder path and the source files) were not reviewed in this session, so open the event if the platform asks for more detail.

How it was found

Window: Oct 15 20:00 to Oct 16 06:00 UTC. A search for archive creation on the file server or by `svc_backup`:

```
principal.namespace = "Cymbal"
AND metadata.event_type = "FILE_CREATION"
AND target.file.full_path = /\.(zip|7z|rar)$/ nocase
AND (principal.hostname = /CYM-FS-01/ nocase OR principal.user.userid =
"svc_backup")
```

Lesson

After lateral movement, attackers collect and stage data before taking it out. Look for archive creation by the new identity on the new host, right after its first logon.

Next pivot

Note the archive name, folder and creation time, then look for where it went next (outbound connections or uploads from CYM-FS-01).